

STAGE FIVE • THINKING, REASONING & MENTAL MODELS

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Five • Thinking, Reasoning & Mental Models

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's pre-work is simple but genuinely important: every session works best when participants arrive with a real, specific problem or decision in mind, not a hypothetical one improvised on the spot.

Before Session 1: Foundational Mental Models

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring to mind one real, current decision or problem you're genuinely facing — this stage works by applying tools to real situations, not hypotheticals.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Nearly every FIRST in this stage asks you to apply a reasoning tool to something real. Arriving with a genuine problem in mind means you spend session time reasoning, not searching for an example.

Before Session 2: Applied Reasoning & Reflection

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Think of one piece of real feedback you've received recently, even something small, for use in FIRST G11.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Feedback integration only works with a real, specific example — having one ready means you're not scrambling to think of something during the exercise itself.

Before Session 3: Advanced Frameworks I

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one real, complex, multi-step decision you're currently facing or expect to face soon. You'll use this same decision across several exercises this session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the longest, most demanding session in the stage. Using one consistent real decision across multiple frameworks, rather than switching examples each time, makes the connections between frameworks much clearer.

Before Session 4: Advanced Frameworks II

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one task you perform repeatedly (school, work, or personal) that could benefit from a written checklist.

WHY THIS MATTERS

FIRST H24 opens this session, and having a real repeated task in mind means you can build something you'll actually use afterward, not a hypothetical example.